

>> freestyle workout

I met someone a long time ago who had developed his own workout. Every day he went to his local park, put on his headphones and danced freestyle for an hour to his favorite music. That's what a freestyle workout should be all about, so have fun, and do it like no one is watching.

There are many different styles of freestyle workouts and training—and they are all constantly changing and evolving—so I'm not even going to attempt to list them or compare the benefits of one with another. Suffice it to say that for this particular sequence, I've borrowed moves from two of my favorite freestyle dance styles—disco and reggae. These moves are designed not only for the enjoyment they offer, but also for their good aerobic workout. And you'll certainly appreciate their waist-trimming effect and how they burn the calories.

The best way to intensify this workout and burn extra calories is to let yourself go and really dance your heart out. You'll be surprised how much fun you have and how quickly you feel you've had a worthwhile workout.

Another way is to maintain your posture and form throughout. One thing you will notice about accomplished and professional dancers, regardless of what style of dance they do, is their beautiful posture. Not only does any movement look better when executed with good form and great posture, but it also has a much more beneficial effect on the body in terms of toning and working core muscles.

In fact, a professional dancer's beautiful posture comes from years of core training—strengthening the lower and upper back, and working all the abdominal muscles, including all the deep muscles we can't see. Try to emulate the professionals and you won't fail to burn extra calories. Keep up the effort in your everyday life, and you'll soon notice the difference.

>> tips for your freestyle workout

- **As with all training and exercise**, you get back what you put in, so even though this workout may appear to be pretty relaxed, do keep working, stay focused, and really twist your waist.
- **Dancing with company** can boost your fun, so try this dance workout with a friend or partner.
- **Forget you are** even doing any “exercise.” Dancing is such an informal way of working your body—especially this relaxed style—so it shouldn't be a chore!

This workout also gives you plenty of opportunity for adding your own special flavor. As soon as you feel you've got the hang of the basic steps, go ahead and add a little hop, or a “shake,” or a hand clap. Make it your own. Keep moving. Have a good time. Persuade a friend or partner to get involved, too, and if you've got small children, you can share the moves with them. Watching them doing their own version of the steps can be priceless!

A freestyle dance workout can help you develop and tone your core muscles. It strengthens your upper and lower back, and works wonders for your abdominal muscles, too.